

WEEKLY CA – 20th June – 26th June

1. Red Road, where the Prime Minister led the Yoga Day celebrations in 2026, is located in:

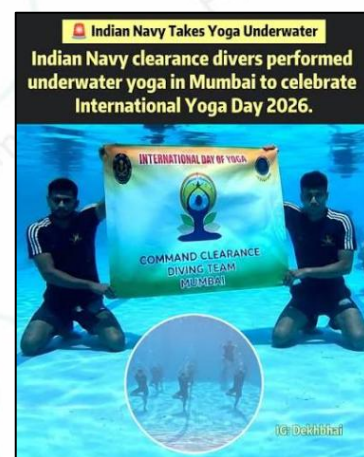
रेड रोड, जहाँ 2026 में प्रधानमंत्री ने योग दिवस समारोह का नेतृत्व किया था, यहाँ स्थित है:

- (a) Mumbai
- (b) Kolkata
- (c) Chennai
- (d) Hyderabad

Answer: (b)

21 June International Day of Yoga

- 2026 Theme: Yoga for Healthy Ageing
- Yoga is an ancient physical, mental and spiritual practice that originated in India.
- The word 'yoga' derives from Sanskrit and means to join or to unite, symbolizing the union of body and consciousness.
- **Celebrated Since:** Officially recognised by UNGA resolution 69/131 on Dec 11, 2014.
- First celebrated globally on June 21, 2015.
- The Indian Navy organised a distinctive underwater yoga session at INS Satvahana to mark the International Day of Yoga 2026.
- As many as 40 submariners performed synchronised yoga postures in water.
- Prime Minister Narendra Modi lead the nation in observing the 12th International Day of Yoga from Red Road in central Kolkata.



Date	Day	Theme
19 June	World Sickle Cell Awareness Day	Closing the Survival Gap: Equity in Sickle Cell Disease
19 June	International Day for the Elimination of Sexual Violence in Conflict	Conflict-Related Sexual Violence Against Children: Safeguarding Futures and Empowering Caregivers
19 June	National Reading Day	
20 June	World Refugee Day	Until Everyone Is Safe
21 June	International Day of the Celebration of the Solstice	
21 June	World Music Day	
21 June	World Hydrography Day	Transforming how ocean data is shared."
22 June	World Camel Day	
22 June	World Rainforest Day	The Forest Within You
23 June	International Olympic Day	
23 June	International Widows' Day	
23 June	United Nations Public Service Day	Transforming Public Institutions: Advancing innovation, Participation, and Inclusion
24 June	International Day of Women in Diplomacy	Women in Diplomacy: Shaping the Future of Global Cooperation
24 June	Passport Seva Divas	
25 June	Day of the Seafarer [IMO]	Carrying world trade. Carrying the risks

Date	Day	Theme
25 June	Samvidhaan Hatya Diwas	
26 June	International Day against Drug Abuse and Illicit Trafficking	World drug problem: persisting issues, new challenges, innovative responses
26 June	United Nations International Day in Support of Victims of Torture	

2. Khurasani Imli, recently awarded a GI tag, is associated with which state?

हाल ही में जीआई टैग से सम्मानित खुरासानी इमली का संबंध किस राज्य से है?

- (a) Rajasthan
- (b) Gujarat
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) Maharashtra

Answer: (c)

The Khurasani Imli, fruit of Mandu's iconic Baobab tree, has been awarded the Geographical Indication (GI) tag

- Khurasani Imli or Tamarind is a fruit of Mandu's (Madhya Pradesh) iconic Baobab tree.
- It was brought to Mandav during the reign of Mahmud Khilji in the 14th century and its name was changed from 'Baobab' to "Khurasani Imli.
- It is known by one more name Mandav Imli.
- It has a light green fruit with a tangy sweet-sour flavour, grows across villages in the Mandu region.
- Benefits
- Tribal communities have traditionally used not only the pulp but also the tree's juice and dried bark for treating ailments such as diabetes.
- It is packed with Vitamin C, antioxidants, and essential minerals.
- Tribal healers have long used it to treat digestive ailments, fever, and fatigue, while seeds and bark also hold medicinal value.



3. With reference to Cham dance, consider the following statements:

It is a sacred masked dance performed by monks.

It symbolizes the victory of good over evil.

It is performed only in Sikkim.

Which of the statement/s given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

Hemis Festival 2026 begins at historic Hemis Monastery in Ladakh

- This year, the festival will be celebrated on June 24 and 25, drawing monks, pilgrims, photographers and travellers from across the world to a remote corner of the Himalayas.
- The Hemis Festival, also known as Hemis Tsechu, commemorates the birth anniversary of **Guru Padmasambhava, also known as Guru Rinpoche**.
- For Buddhists, Guru Padmasambhava occupies a position comparable to that of a great spiritual teacher and reformer.
- He is credited with spreading Vajrayana Buddhism across Tibet and the Himalayan region during the eighth century.
- According to Buddhist traditions, he is believed to have subdued negative forces and transformed them into protectors of the faith.
- His teachings continue to influence Buddhist communities across Ladakh, Tibet, Bhutan, Nepal and parts of India.
- The festival is observed according to the Tibetan lunar calendar and falls on the tenth day of the fifth lunar month each year.
- The highlight is the Cham dance, a sacred masked dance performed by monks of the Hemis Monastery.
- Each mask, costume and movement carries religious symbolism, depicting stories of good triumphing over evil, the cycle of life and death, and the teachings of Guru Padmasambhava.



4. Recently, the Supreme Court declared that the freedom to walk on demarcated and well-maintained footpaths is a:

हाल ही में, सुप्रीम कोर्ट ने घोषणा की कि सीमांकित और अच्छी तरह से बनाए गए फुटपथों पर चलने की स्वतंत्रता है:

- Legal privilege
- Directive Principle
- Fundamental Right
- Statutory Right

Answer: (c)

Supreme Court declares the right to walk carefree on footpaths a fundamental right

- A two-judge bench of Justices P.S. Narasimha and A.S. Chandurkar were acting in the case of a man named Maniyar Iliyaz, who lost his five-year-old son to an accident in which a tanker struck him from behind, crushing his lower body in the process.
- **The Supreme Court in a judgment, declared the freedom to walk on demarcated and well-maintained footpaths a fundamental right which has priority over movement by motorised vehicles.**
- This is an enforceable duty.
- The fundamental right to walk on demarcated footpaths shall override the privilege of a motorised vehicle
- **“The right to walk is a fundamental right under Part III of the Constitution. It is integral to the right to movement guaranteed under Article 19(1)(d), read with Article 19(1)(a), Article 19(1)(b), Article 19(1)(c) and Article 21 of the Constitution of India.**



- The **fundamental right to walk will take within its sweep the right to demarcated footpaths**. These rights are primary and shall have priority over movement by motorised vehicles.

5. Which state received the Best State Association Award at the Indian Athletics Awards 2026?

भारतीय एथलेटिक्स पुरस्कार 2026 में किस राज्य को सर्वश्रेष्ठ राज्य संघ का पुरस्कार मिला?

- (a) Maharashtra
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Tamil Nadu
- (d) Kerala

Answer: (c)

The inaugural Indian Athletics Awards

- Hosted by the Athletics Federation of India (AFI), the ceremony in New Delhi celebrated outstanding achievements from the 2025 season
- The event featured 10 categories, including Best Female Athlete, Best Coach, Best Technical Official, Best State Association and Lifetime Achievement Award.
- The awardees:
 - Athlete of the Year (women): Parul Chaudhary; (Rs. 10,00,000)
 - Athlete of the Year (men): Neeraj Chopra; (Rs. 10,00,000)
 - Emerging Athlete (women): Pooja (high jump); (Rs. 2,50,000)
 - Emerging Athlete (men): Shahnaz Khan (long jump); (Rs. 2,50,000)
 - Best Coach: Parvir Singh (throws);
 - Best Sponsor: Reliance Foundation;
 - Lifetime achievement: P.T. Usha, G.S. Randhawa, Bahadur Singh Chauhan, Anju Bobby George; (Rs. 5,00,000)
 - Best State for supporting athletes: Odisha;
 - Best State association: Tamil Nadu;
 - Best technical official: Dr. Kuldeep Singh.



6. The recently revived Qadian-Beas New Railway Line Project is located in which state?

हाल ही में पुनर्जीवित कादियान-ब्यास नई रेलवे लाइन परियोजना किस राज्य में स्थित है?

- (a) Haryana
- (b) Punjab
- (c) Himachal Pradesh
- (d) Rajasthan

Answer: (b)

The Qadian-Beas Railway Line Project

- **The Government of India has officially revived the long-pending Qadian-Beas New Railway Line Project in Punjab's Majha region after nearly a century of delays.**
- The Qadian-Beas New Railway Line Project is a highly strategic and culturally significant infrastructure project revival.



- It falls under the Government of India's Socially Desirable Rail Connectivity Programme, aiming to bring historically disconnected towns onto the national broad-gauge network while serving as an alternative emergency line for northern train operations.
- **Location:**
- **State and Belt:** The project is located entirely within the Majha region of Punjab, India.
- **Connecting Nodes:** The corridor physically links Qadian (situated in the Gurdaspur district) with Beas (located in the Amritsar district).
- The rail link traces its origin to the late 1928–29 fiscal year, when it was formally sanctioned by the British-run North-Western Railway.
- The line features a 39.68-kilometer broad-gauge layout built to modern weight-bearing and high-speed safety parameters.

7. In Sahariya Swang dance, a distinctive feature is:

सहरिया स्वांग नृत्य की एक विशिष्ट विशेषता है:

- Only group singing without instruments
- Use of classical Bharatnatyam mudras
- Male performer often dressed in female attire
- Performed only inside temples

Answer: C

Sahariya Tribe

- The President recently interacted with Cheetah Mitras and members of the Sahariya tribe at Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh's Sheopur district.
- It is one of the Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTG).
- They are also called by the names Seher, Sair, Savar, Saonar, Sahra, etc.
- They live on the margins — in the forests and villages of Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan.
- They mostly live in a distinct settlement called 'Seharana' which is generally a cluster of houses.
- The houses are made of some stone boulders, and the roofing is also made of stone slabs – locally called Patore.
- In some villages, mud structures are also constructed.
- Religion: They practice Hinduism infused with veneration of local deities like Bhavani, Gond Devta, and Bijasur, alongside animistic elements tied to their jungle-dwelling heritage.
- The Saharia are divided into five sub-tribes: the Jati, Arsi, Muli, Kindal, and Kumbi.
- The Jati are farmers; the Arsi are weavers; the Muli are iron workers; the Kindal are basket makers; and the Kumbi are potters.
- They are known for their dance, the Saharia Swang, which is performed during the month of Holi.
- The dance is performed to the beats of the dhol, nagari, and matki.
- It features a male dressed in female attire who dances around the male performers.
- They are particularly skilled in making catechu from khair trees.



8. Abhigyan, recently launched by the NCRB, is associated with which of the following?

NCRB द्वारा हाल ही में लॉन्च किया गया 'अभिज्ञान' (Abhigyan) निम्नलिखित में से किससे संबंधित है?

- (a) Fingerprint identification and management
- (b) Cybercrime investigation
- (c) Financial fraud detection
- (d) Border security surveillance

Answer: (a)

The 26th All India Fingerprint Conference 2026

- Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Shri Amit Shah addressed the inaugural session of the **26th All India Fingerprint Conference 2026 in New Delhi**
- The Home Minister also launched the National Crime Records Bureau's (NCRB) Abhigyan, CrPI, e-Prosecution 2.0 and e-Forensics 2.0 applications
- **Abhigyan**, an app developed by the National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) to implement the procedure, was launched by Home Minister Amit Shah
- The app links to the National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS), which stores fingerprint scans of accused, convicts, and those in prisons on a centralised platform.



9. François Englert, who recently passed away, was best known for his contribution to the discovery of which of the following particles?

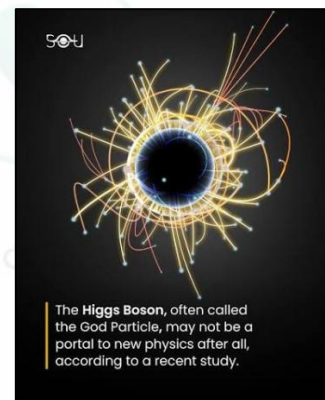
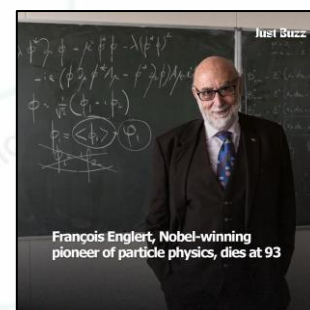
हाल ही में गुजरने वाले फ्राँस्वा एंग्लर्ट, इनमें से किस कण की खोज में अपने योगदान के लिए सबसे ज़्यादा जाने जाते थे?

- (a) Neutrino
- (b) Graviton
- (c) Positron
- (d) Higgs Boson

Answer: (d)

François Englert of Higgs boson fame passes away at 93

- The Belgian physicist and Nobel laureate François Englert passed away
- Englert's best known work paved the way for the **discovery of the Higgs boson in 2012**.
- The Higgs boson became popular as the "god particle" worldwide and settled a long-standing problem in physics
- He published a landmark paper titled 'Broken Symmetry and the Mass of Gauge Vector Mesons'.
- It proposed what is now known as the Brout-Englert-Higgs (BEH) mechanism.



10. Which of the following best describes the primary objective of SHATAYU Dashboard?

निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा SHATAYU डैशबोर्ड के प्राथमिक उद्देश्य का सबसे अच्छा वर्णन करता है?

- A. Providing digital skill training to rural youth

- B. Monitoring implementation of old-age pension schemes
- C. Promoting startup incubation in the social sector
- D. Facilitating linkage between trained caregivers and senior citizens

Answer: d

SHATAYU Dashboard Expands Caregiver Network for Senior Citizens across the country

- The Department of Social Justice and Empowerment has launched SHATAYU (Senior Holistic Care Assistance and Training for Your Utility) Dashboard on 22.05.2026.
- The dashboard provides a platform to **all trained Geriatric caregivers to register themselves on the dashboard for providing their services to the needy senior citizens.**
- The SHATAYU dashboard is managed by National Institute of Social Defence (NISD), an autonomous body of Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment which is also mandated with the training of geriatric caregivers.



11. Who has been elected as India's Judge to the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS) for the 2026-2035 term?

2026-2035 के कार्यकाल के लिए 'इंटरनेशनल ट्रिब्यूनल फॉर द लॉ ऑफ़ द सी' (ITLOS) में भारत के जज के तौर पर किसे चुना गया है?

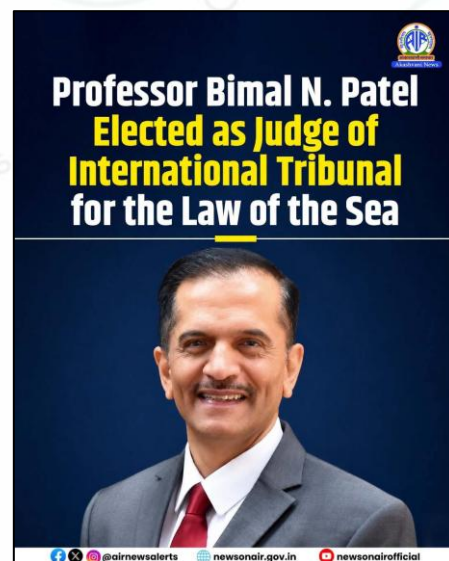
- (a) Bimal N. Patel
- (b) Harish Salve
- (c) Dalveer Bhandari
- (d) T.S. Tirumurti

Answer: (a)

- **India's candidate, Professor Bimal N. Patel, has been elected as a Judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS) for the 2026-2035 term**
- India's candidate, Professor Bimal N. Patel has been elected as a Judge of the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS) for the 2026-2035 term.
- It is an **independent judicial body established by the 1982 United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea.**

Composition

- The Tribunal is composed of 21 independent members.
- Members elected by secret ballot by the States Parties to the Convention.
- Each State Party may nominate up to two candidates.
- The **seat of the Tribunal is in the City of Hamburg, Germany.**



12. Consider the following statements regarding Rakhigarhi:

The site was first excavated by Sir John Marshall in 1921.

The site has evidence of a sophisticated drainage system with covered wastewater channels.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

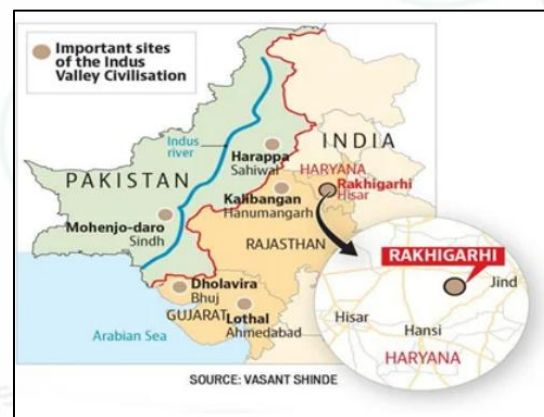
- (a) 1 only

- (b) 2 only
 (c) Both 1 and 2
 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: b

ASI transfers 'Rakhigarhi' skeletons to Anthropological Survey of India for further research

- Human skeletal remains excavated from the archaeological site of Rakhigarhi in Haryana have been formally handed over by the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) to the **Anthropological Survey of India (AnSI)**, a national research institute under the Ministry of Culture, for **detailed scientific investigation**.
- Rakhigarhi is an ancient Bronze Age metropolis that stands as the largest known urban settlement of the Indus-Saraswati (Harappan) Civilization.
- The site documents thousands of years of continuous human habitation, showcasing a complete evolutionary stratigraphy from the Early (Pre-Harappan) to the Mature Harappan periods.
- River Plain Basin:** Located within the fertile **Ghaggar-Hakra** river plain, along the **dry paleo-bed of the seasonal Sarasvati River**.
- The site was first identified and documented by the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) in the 1960s, with pioneering documentation carried out by **Professor Suraj Bhan in 1969**.



Key Features of the Site:

- Houses were constructed using standardized burnt and mud terracotta bricks along paved public roads stretching up to 1.92 meters wide.
- Features complex, brick-lined **covered wastewater drains** running from individual households directly into main street sewage channels.
- Discovered in the Mature Harappan layers, this public granary features mud-brick construction and seven large rectangular chambers.
- Mound No. 1 served as an ancient manufacturing zone, yielding **cloth-dyeing installations, terracotta firing kilns**, and a specialized **gold foundry** containing a furnace and over 3,000 unpolished semi-precious gemstones.

Anthropological Survey of India

- It is a government-funded organization that conducts anthropological research and studies on the diverse cultures of India.
- It is the only research organization to pursue anthropological research in the Central Government under the **Ministry of Culture**.

Headquarters: Kolkata, West Bengal.

- It was established in 1945 under the leadership of Dr. S.C. Roy, a renowned anthropologist.



13. The Indian Navy's frontline platforms INS Dunagiri, Sanshodhak and Agray, recently commissioned in Kolkata, were built by which of the following shipyards?

भारतीय नौसेना के फ्रंटलाइन प्लेटफॉर्म INS दुनागिरी, संशोधक और एग्रे, जिन्हें हाल ही में कोलकाता में कमीशन किया गया था, निम्नलिखित में से किस शिपयार्ड द्वारा बनाए गए थे?

- (a) Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL)
- (b) Cochin Shipyard Limited (CSL)
- (c) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers Ltd. (GRSE)
- (d) Goa Shipyard Limited (GSL)

Answer: (c)

PM commission three indigenous naval platforms in Kolkata

- The Indian Navy commissioned three indigenously built frontline platforms—Dunagiri, Sanshodhak, and Agray—in Kolkata.
- Designed by the Indian Navy's Warship Design Bureau and built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE), the three vessels have indigenous content exceeding 75 per cent and involved the participation of more than 200 MSMEs.

INS Dunagiri

- It is the fifth Project 17A stealth frigate.
- It is equipped with advanced weapons and sensors, including BrahMos surface-to-surface missiles and the Medium Range Surface-to-Air Missile system, significantly enhancing the Navy's combat capability.

Sanshodhak

- It is the fourth Survey Vessel (Large).
- Function: It is designed for coastal and deep-water hydrographic surveys and collection of oceanographic and geophysical data for defence and civil applications.
- It is equipped with advanced survey systems including Autonomous Underwater Vehicles and Remotely Operated Vehicles.

Agray

- It is the fourth of the Arnala-class Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft.
- It is equipped with lightweight torpedoes, indigenous rocket launchers, and shallow-water sonar systems to detect and engage underwater threats in littoral waters.



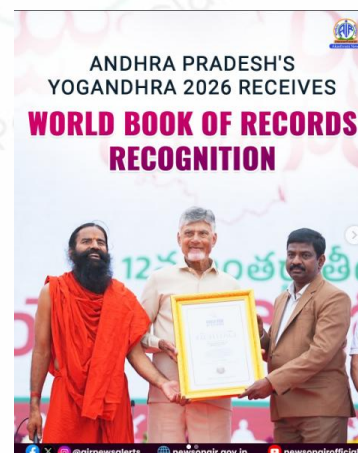
14. The World Book of Records recently recognized Andhra Pradesh's flagship initiative 'Yogandhra 2026' for achieving which of the following milestones?

वर्ल्ड बुक ऑफ रिकॉर्ड्स ने हाल ही में निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा मील का पत्थर हासिल करने के लिए आंध्र प्रदेश की प्रमुख पहल 'योगंध्र 2026' को मान्यता दी है?

- (a) Establishing the world's largest yoga training centre
- (b) Organizing the largest yoga-themed marathon
- (c) Mobilizing large-scale public participation in yoga across the state
- (d) Conducting the longest continuous yoga session by a single individual

Answer: (c)

- **Andhra Pradesh's flagship mass yoga initiative, Yogandhra 2026, receives international recognition from the World Book of Records**
- Andhra Pradesh's flagship mass yoga initiative, Yogandhra 2026, has received international recognition from the World Book of Records for its large-scale public participation and successful promotion of yoga across the state.



- The state had set a target of involving 1.05 crore yoga enthusiasts under Yogandhra 2026, but participation surpassed expectations, with more than 1.07 crore people registering, marking a major milestone.

15. Smart Seed Coating Technology, recently developed in India, has been developed by:

हाल ही में भारत में विकसित स्मार्ट सीड कोटिंग टेक्नोलॉजी किसके द्वारा विकसित की गई है:

- (a) ICAR–National Rice Research Institute, Cuttack
- (b) ICAR–Indian Agricultural Research Institute, New Delhi
- (c) ICAR–Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research, Hyderabad
- (d) ICAR–Central Research Institute for Dryland Agriculture, Hyderabad

Answer: c

Smart Seed Coating Technology

- Recently, the Indian Council of Agricultural Research's Indian Institute of Oilseeds Research (ICAR-IIOR), Hyderabad, has developed Smart Seed Coating Technology.
- It is an innovative biopolymer-based technology.
- It **uses biodegradable biopolymers to form a multifunctional protective layer around seeds.**
- This coating acts as a delivery platform for beneficial microorganisms, nutrients, micronutrients, crop protection agents, and crop-protection agents directly at the seed-soil interface, improving germination rates and early plant growth,
- It **creates a favourable microenvironment that promotes faster germination, stronger seedling growth, better root development, and enhanced tolerance to both biotic and abiotic stresses during the crucial crop establishment phase.**
- The coating can be tailored for a broad range of crops, including cereals, millets, pulses, vegetables, and horticultural produce, and is particularly suited to rainfed farming,

16. The doctrine of Res Judicata means:

'रेस ज्यूडिकाटा' (Res Judicata) के सिद्धांत का अर्थ है:

- A. Law applies equally to all
- B. A matter once decided cannot be re-litigated
- C. Courts can review their own judgments anytime
- D. Only higher courts can decide disputes

Answer: B

Doctrine of Constructive Res Judicata

- The Supreme Court recently reiterated that the doctrine of constructive res judicata, embodied in Explanation IV to Section 11 of the Code of Civil Procedure, is aimed at preventing parties from litigating in installments and ensuring finality in judicial proceedings.
- The concept of res judicata has evolved from the English Common Law System.
- Res judicata literally means 'the thing has been judged'. It is also known as claim preclusion.
- The principle of res judicata applies when a litigant attempts to file a subsequent lawsuit on the same matter after having received a judgment in a previous case involving the same parties.
- It means that the issue before the court has already been decided by another court, between the same parties, and the courts do not allow a petition to be filed in the same court or in another court.
- Therefore, the court will dismiss the case before it as being useless.
- Res Judicata as a concept is applicable both in Civil as well as Criminal legal system.

- Constructive Res Judicata is an extension of the principle of Res Judicata.
- It applies to matters that could have been raised in a previous suit but were not.

17. India ranked ____ in the Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026.

ऊर्जा संक्रमण सूचकांक (ईटीआई) 2026 में भारत ____ स्थान पर है।

- (a) 68th
(b) 69th
(c) 70th
(d) 72nd

Answer: (c)

Energy Transition Index

- India moved up two places to rank 70th in the Energy Transition Index (ETI) 2026.
- It is released by the World Economic Forum.
- It evaluates countries on energy security, sustainability and equity, along with the readiness of their policy, financial and infrastructure environments to support the transition.
- A country's final ETI score is a weighted composite of two sub-indices: system performance (60%) and transition readiness (40%).
- ETI scores use a 0-100 scale, with 100 representing the highest global performance for each indicator and index component.
- Key Findings of Energy Transition Index**
- Sweden, Finland and Denmark retained their top three positions globally
- Singapore posted one of the largest improvements, climbing 10 places to 42nd due to stronger regulations and political commitment.
- Six G20 members featured in the top 20: Germany (9th), France (10th), the United Kingdom (11th), China (14th), Brazil (17th) and the United States (19th).

Energy Transition Index 2026: Top 15 countries

WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM

Top 15 countries in 2026

		2026 ETI score	Change since 2017 (%)
1	Sweden	75.3	▲ 4.0
2	Finland	74.1	▲ 5.3
3	Denmark	72.6	▼ -0.7
4	Estonia	70.9	▲ 7.0
5	Norway	70.5	▲ 0.6
6	Switzerland	70.2	▲ 5.8
7	Latvia	70.0	▲ 4.6
8	Austria	69.7	▲ 1.2
9	Germany	69.6	▲ 2.2
10	France	68.3	▲ 3.1
11	United Kingdom	68.2	▼ -2.4
12	Israel	67.5	▲ 9.3
13	Netherlands	67.4	▲ 1.3
14	China	66.9	▲ 5.8
15	Portugal	66.7	▲ 7.5

Source: World Economic Forum, (2026), Energy Transition Index 2026.

18. Paschim Banga Dibas commemorates which of the following events?

पश्चिम बंग दिवस निम्नलिखित में से किस घटना का स्मरण कराता है?

- (a) Resolution for the partition of Bengal moved in the Bengal Legislative Assembly in 1947
(b) Adoption of the Constitution of India
(c) Formation of the State of West Bengal in 1950
(d) Merger of princely states with West Bengal

Answer: (a)

Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi participates in Paschimbanga Divas celebrations in Hooghly, West Bengal

- The Bharatiya Janata Party government, after coming to power, had announced that it would observe **June 20 as Paschim Banga Dibas**.



- On June 20, 1947 Jana Sangh founder **Syama Prasad Mookerjee moved the proposal in the Bengal Legislative Assembly for the partition of Bengal**, which paved the way for the creation of a “homeland for Hindus of Bengal”
- The theme for this year’s Paschimbanga Divas: **“West Bengal: Heritage, Harmony and Development,”**

19. Who will represent India as Vice-President of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) for the term July 2026–June 2027?

जुलाई 2026-जून 2027 की अवधि के लिए वित्तीय कार्रवाई कार्य बल (एफएटीएफ) के उपाध्यक्ष के रूप में भारत का प्रतिनिधित्व कौन करेगा?

- (a) T. V. Somanathan
- (b) Ajay Seth
- (c) Vivek Aggarwal
- (d) M. Nagaraju

Answer: (c)

India has been elected to the Vice-Presidency of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) for the first time.

- India has been elected to the Vice-Presidency of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) for the first time.
- Shri Vivek Aggarwal, Secretary in the Ministry of Culture, will serve in this leadership role for the July 2026 to June 2027 term.
- It is an independent intergovernmental body that develops and promotes policies to protect the global financial system against money laundering and terrorist financing.
- Origin
- It was established in 1989 during the G7 Summit in Paris in response to a growing concern about money laundering.
- **In 2001, its mandate expanded to include terrorism financing.**
- **Headquarters: Paris, France.**
- Members: FATF members include 40 countries, including the United States, India, China, Saudi Arabia, Britain, Germany, France, and the EU as such.
- **India became a member of FATF in 2010.**
- **Democratic People's Republic of Korea (North Korea) , Iran , Myanmar are currently in Black list of FATF**



20. Solanum pandeyi, recently discovered in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, is a species of:

सोलनम पांडेई, हाल ही में अंडमान और निकोबार द्वीप समूह में खोजी गई, एक प्रजाति है:

- (a) Wild Chilli
- (b) Wild Brinjal
- (c) Wild Tomato
- (d) Wild Potato

Answer: (b)

New species of wild brinjal discovered in the Andamans

- A new species of wild brinjal has been discovered from one of the remote islands of the Andaman and Nicobar archipelago by a scientist from the Botanical Survey of India (BSI).
- The species, **Solanum pandeyi**, was recorded in the evergreen forest of **Middle Andaman** by Lal Ji Singh, head of the BSI Andaman and Nicobar regional centre.
- The plant was used by an **indigenous Negrito tribe, Great Andamanese**, for food and medicinal purposes.
- Most seeds and roots are used to treat **tooth infection**.
- The species *Solanum pandeyi* is named after **Arun Kumar Pandey**, professor, Department of Botany, University of Delhi, for his significant contributions to plant systematics



21. Sufiyana Mousiqi, recently seen in news, is bidding for inclusion in the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage list from which state?

हाल ही में खबरों में देखी गई सूफियाना मौसीकी किस राज्य से यूनेस्को अमूर्त सांस्कृतिक विरासत सूची में शामिल होने के लिए बोली लगा रही हैं?

- A. Punjab
- B. Rajasthan
- C. Jammu & Kashmir
- D. Gujarat

Answer: C

Kashmir's Sufiyana Music bids for UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list

- Sufiyana Mousiqi, believed to be in practice since the 15th Century in Kashmir with its muqams or ragas, is for the first time bidding for the inclusion in list of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity of United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO).
- Sufiyana music represents a remarkable synthesis of devotional poetry, classical melody, and philosophical depth.
- Sufiyana Mousiqi emerged between the 14th and 15th centuries, when Kashmir became a cross-cultural link for India, Persia, Central Asia, and the wider Islamic world.
- Sufiyana Mausiki had around fifty-four maqams or ragas and only 20-25 are in practice now.
- Most Sufiyana Mausiki opens with an instrumental prelude and a short poem sung without rhythm.
- It uses specific instruments of santoor, ney (a type of flute), harmonium, rabab, tabla and sitar.



22. Which of the following best describes the eligibility criteria for the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar (PMRBP)?

इनमें से कौन-सा विकल्प 'प्रधानमंत्री राष्ट्रीय बाल पुरस्कार' (PMRBP) के लिए पात्रता मानदंडों का सबसे अच्छा वर्णन करता है?

- A. Children aged 0–18 years with international achievements only
- B. Indian citizens aged 5–18 years with achievements in the last 2 years
- C. Any child residing in India below 18 years
- D. Indian citizens aged 10–18 years with lifetime achievements

Answer: B

Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar

- The Ministry of Women and Child Development has invited nominations for the Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar (PMRBP) 2026.
- It is the nation's highest civilian honour for children.
- It is presented annually by the President of India on Veer Bal Diwas.
- Veer Bal Diwas is observed annually on December 26 in memory of Sahibzada Zorawar Singh and Sahibzada Fateh Singh.
- It recognises exceptional achievements in six distinct categories namely: Bravery, Social Service, Environment, Sports, Art and Culture, Science and Technology.
- Eligibility for Pradhan Mantri Rashtriya Bal Puraskar
- Citizenship: A child should be an Indian Citizen.
- Age: A child above the age of 5 years and not exceeding 18 years (as of 31st July of respective year).
- The act/incident/achievement should have been within 2 years of the last date of receipt of application/nomination for the year of consideration.
- The number of awards will be 25, however, any relaxation to this maximum number may be permitted at the discretion of the National Selection Committee.
- A child may be nominated in more than one category, although the committee reserves the right to consider only one application.
- Any individual or institution can nominate a child. Children may also apply through self-nomination.
- Recommendations are also invited from certain government entities and offices.
- Each awardee is given a medal, a cash prize of Rs. 1 Lakh and certificate



23. Which country topped the QS World Future Skills Index 2027?

QS वर्ल्ड फ्यूचर स्किल्स इंडेक्स 2027 में कौन सा देश शीर्ष पर रहा?

- A. United Kingdom
- B. Australia
- C. United States
- D. Canada

Answer: C

India ranks 13th globally for AI-Economy readiness: QS World Future Skills Index 2027

- India has secured the 13th position globally in the QS World Future Skills Index 2027,
- The QS World Future Skills Index measures how well countries are prepared for the future of work.
- The US topped the global rankings followed by Australia and the UK.



Rank	Economy	Overall Score (/100)	Balance Index	Primary Strength
1	United States	99	1	Skills Alignment
2	Australia	98	1	Academic Readiness
3	United Kingdom	97	4	Academic Readiness
4	Germany	96	4	Future of Work
5	Canada	94	3	Academic Readiness

Indian Performance by Indicator - QS World Future Skills Index 2027		
Indicator	Score/100	Global Rank
Skills Alignment	82.7	18
Academic Readiness	85.7	22
Future of Work	96.0	5
Economic Transformation	93.3	14
Overall	89.4	13

24. The first indigenous Air Cushion Vehicle (ACV), designated as H-561, recently inducted into the Indian Coast Guard, was built by which company?

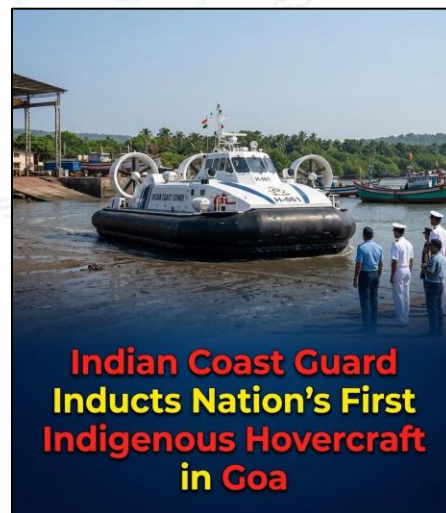
पहला स्वदेशी एयर कुशन वाहन (ACV), जिसे H-561 के रूप में नामित किया गया है, हाल ही में भारतीय तटरक्षक बल में शामिल किया गया, किस कंपनी द्वारा बनाया गया था?

- (a) Garden Reach Shipbuilders & Engineers (GRSE)
- (b) Goa Shipyard Limited
- (c) Chowgule & Company Private Limited
- (d) Cochin Shipyard Limited

Answer: (c)

India Inducts First Indigenous Hovercraft into Coast Guard

- The **Indian Coast Guard inducted its first indigenous Air Cushion Vehicle, designated H-561.**
- The **hovercraft was built at Chowgule & Company Private Limited's shipyard in Goa** and is the first of six indigenous ACVs under construction for the force.
- An Air Cushion Vehicle is a hovercraft that moves on a cushion of air created by fans or lift systems.
- ACVs can operate over shallow water, mudflats, beaches, marshy terrain, and other low-support surfaces.



25. "VIP Culture in India: Power, Privilege and the Distance from Democracy" has been authored by:

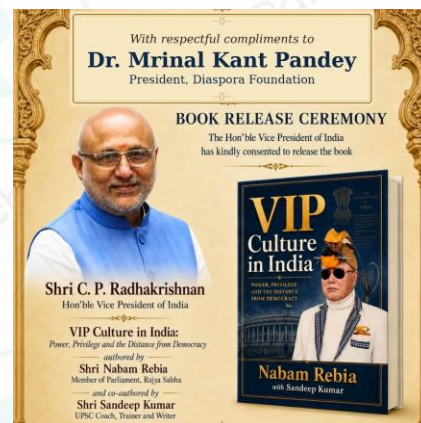
"भारत में वीआईपी संस्कृति: शक्ति, विशेषाधिकार और लोकतंत्र से दूरी" किसके द्वारा लिखी गई है:

- A. Nabam Rebia and Sandeep Kumar
- B. Venkaiah Naidu and Sanjay Baru
- C. P. Chidambaram and Shashi Tharoor
- D. Arun Jaitley and Bibek Debroy

Answer: A

VP Radhakrishnan Releases Book "VIP Culture in India: Power, Privilege and the Distance from Democracy"

- The Vice-President of India, Shri C. P. Radhakrishnan, today released the book "VIP Culture in India: Power, Privilege and the Distance from Democracy" at Uprashtrapati Bhavan, New Delhi.
- authors, former Rajya Sabha Member from Arunachal Pradesh Shri Nabam Rebia and co-author Shri Sandeep Kumar.



26. The Youth Co:Lab initiative is co-led in India by:

भारत में यूथ को:लैब पहल का सह-नेतृत्व किसके द्वारा किया जाता है:

- A. NITI Aayog and World Bank
- B. United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) India and Citi Foundation
- C. United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) and International Monetary Fund (IMF)
- D. Asian Development Bank (ADB) and World Health Organization (WHO)

Answer: B

Six youth-led startups win Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026

- Six youth-led startups from across India have been recognized as winners of the 8th edition of the Youth Co:Lab National Innovation Challenge 2026 for developing innovative solutions that advance sustainability through circular economy innovations, sustainable textiles and fashion, and sustainable food systems and water conservation.
- Co-led by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) India and Citi Foundation, in partnership with Atal Innovation Mission (AIM), and implemented by T-Hub Foundation,
- The participating startups worked across three thematic areas:
 - Sustainable Textiles and Fashion
 - Circular Economy Innovations
 - Sustainable Food Systems and Water Conservation
- The three winning startups received seed grant support of ₹3,50,000 each, along with capacity-building opportunities and ecosystem access.
- The three runners-up were awarded ₹2,20,000 each in recognition of their promising contributions and potential for scale.



About Youth Co:Lab

- Co-created in 2017 by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) and the Citi Foundation,
- Youth Co:Lab aims to establish a common agenda for countries in the Asia-Pacific region to empower and invest in youth so that they can accelerate the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) through leadership, social innovation, and entrepreneurship

27. The Choglamsar Park and Stakna Floriculture Project, recently in the news, are located in which State/Union Territory?

हाल ही में चर्चा में रहे चोगलमसर पार्क और स्टकना फ्लोरीकल्चर प्रोजेक्ट किस राज्य/केंद्र शासित प्रदेश में स्थित हैं?

- (a) Jammu & Kashmir

- (b) Himachal Pradesh
- (c) Ladakh
- (d) Uttarakhand

Answer: (c)

Ladakh Gets Two High-Altitude Flower Fields

- Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena laid the foundation stone for two high-altitude flower fields in Leh, first-of-its-kind high-altitude Flower Fields.
- The two flower fields at **Choglamsar and Stakna in Leh** will be the first such high-altitude projects in the country.



28. The Great Tang Records on the Western Regions was authored by:

पश्चिमी क्षेत्रों पर ग्रेट टैंग रिकॉर्ड्स किसके द्वारा लिखे गए थे:

- (a) Fa-Hien
- (b) Xuanzang
- (c) I-Tsing
- (d) Megasthenes

Answer: (b)

UNESCO nominations for Xuanzang's work

- India and China are in advanced stages of discussions over a joint nomination for **'The Great Tang Records on the Western Regions'**.
- The Great Tang Records on the Western Regions is a narrative of Chinese Buddhist monk and scholar Xuanzang's travels through medieval India in the 7th century.
- The accounts of Xuanzang, also known as Hiuen Tsang, who spent 19 years travelling through India, remain a source for the study of early medieval India.
- He travelled across India from 629–645 CE in search of Buddhist manuscripts and "correct" teachings.
- He spent roughly **five years in Nalanda**, where he studied under the mahavihara's grand abbot, **Silabhadra**.
- Xuanzang wrote that 500 merchants bought the land on which the mahavihara would eventually stand for 10 lakh pieces of gold and presented it to the Buddha, who preached there for three months.
- According to Xuanzang, **the first vihara was built at the site in the 1st century BCE**.
- India also aims at securing a place for Panchtantra on the UNESCO list; as also for the philosophy of **Satyagraha along with South Africa**.

ThePrint
EXCLUSIVE



A monk who bridged two nations:
India, China eye joint UNESCO
recognition for shared Xuanzang legacy

Follow us on

29. Exercise KHAAN QUEST, recently in the news, is hosted by:

व्यायाम खान क्वेस्ट, जो हाल ही में खबरों में है, की मेजबानी किसके द्वारा की गई है:

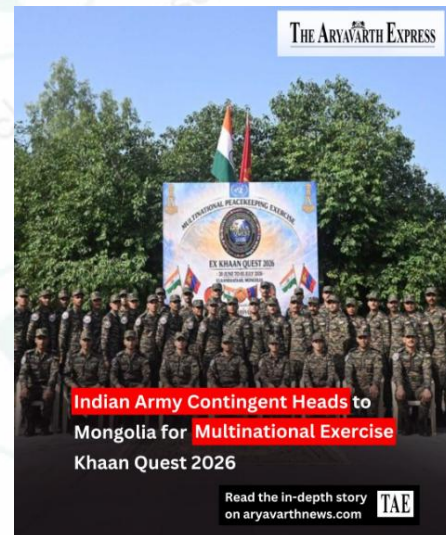
- (a) United States Army
- (b) Russian Armed Forces
- (c) People's Liberation Army of China

(d) Mongolian Armed Forces

Answer: (d)

Exercise Khaan Quest

- The Indian Army contingent is set to depart to participate in the multilateral **joint military exercise – Exercise KHAAN QUEST**.
- It is an annual, multinational joint military exercise.
- It is **hosted by the Mongolian Armed Forces and co-sponsored by the U.S. Pacific Command**.
- It aims to enhance interoperability and cooperation among participating militaries in peace support operations under Chapter VII of the United Nations Charter.
- The **exercise first started as a bilateral event between the USA and Mongolian Armed Forces in the year 2003**.
- Subsequently, from the year 2006 onwards, the exercise graduated to a multinational peacekeeping exercise.
- The last edition of Exercise KHAAN QUEST was conducted in Mongolia in 2025.
- It is **the 23rd iteration of the exercise**.
- It is scheduled to be held from 20 June to 3 July at the Five Hills Training Area in Ulaanbaatar (capital of Mongolia).
- **The Indian Army contingent comprises 40 personnel, including troops from a battalion of the JAT Regiment and personnel from other Arms and Services.**



30. With reference to Thewa Art, consider the following statements:

It originated during the Mughal period in Rajasthan.

Thewa Art uses lac-resin as a base for fixing gold sheets.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

The Prime Minister of India presented Thewa motif cufflinks to the Slovak President in his recent visit to Slovakia

- It is a unique form of jewelry making that is completely handcrafted.
- It is an intricate and elegant form of jewelry-making that involves fusing gold onto colored glass to create intricate designs and patterns.
- It was evolved in **Pratapgarh district of Rajasthan**,
- It is a 400- year-old art work that was first crafted by Nathu Lal Sonewal in the 18th century.
- The word Thewa is derived from the local dialect of the region and means 'setting'.
- The Thewa Art work received its Geographical Indication (GI) tag in 2014.



- The core uniqueness of Thewa lies in its secret thermal bonding process; hand-carved 23-carat gold foil is permanently fused onto a base of multi-colored glass without using any glue, solder, or synthetic pasting materials.

31. What is the Turquoise Nexus Initiative (TNI)?

फ़िरोज़ा नेक्सस पहल (TNI) क्या है?

- (a) A global carbon market mechanism
- (b) An initiative integrating food, water and climate adaptation into national climate plans
- (c) A renewable energy financing programme
- (d) A biodiversity conservation initiative

Answer: (b)

Turquoise Nexus Initiative

- Turkey's Presidency of 2026 UNFCCC COP31 and Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) have introduced the **Turquoise Nexus Initiative (TNI)**.
- It is aimed at integrating food security, water management and climate adaptation into national climate plans.
- It is unveiled by Turkey's upcoming COP31 Presidency and Food and Agriculture Organization.
- It is a proposed programme under FAO's multistakeholder Food and Agriculture for Sustainable Transformation (FAST) Partnership which was launched by the COP27 Presidency in 2022 in Sharm el-Sheikh, Egypt.



32. The 3D-printed artificial reef project, recently seen in the news, has been developed by Chennai-based startup Tvasta in collaboration with which of the following institutions?

हाल ही में समाचारों में देखी गई 3डी-मुद्रित कृत्रिम चट्टान परियोजना, चेन्नई स्थित स्टार्टअप ट्वास्ता द्वारा निम्नलिखित में से किस संस्थान के सहयोग से विकसित की गई है?

- (a) National Institute of Ocean Technology (NIOT)
- (b) ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI)
- (c) National Centre for Coastal Research (NCCR)
- (d) Zoological Survey of India (ZSI)

Answer: (b)

India's first 3D-Printed Artificial Reef Modules.

- Tamil Nadu is set to deploy India's first 3D-printed **artificial reef modules in coastal waters as part of an ambitious marine habitat restoration** initiative under the second phase of the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana.
- It is to be deployed by Tamil Nadu in coastal waters off the Ramanathapuram coast under the second phase of the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana.
- The modules, each weighing about 1 tonne, were developed by Chennai-based startup Tvasta, an IIT Madras-incubated company, in collaboration with Visakhapatnam Regional Centre of the ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute.



- These modules will be deployed about two nautical miles offshore.
- Unlike conventional artificial reefs made from reinforced concrete structures, the new modules feature complex geometries with multiple crevices, folds and attachment surfaces designed to enhance biodiversity.

33. Which one of the following GI-tagged products and its State/UT of origin is correctly matched?

इनमें से कौन-सा GI-टैग वाला उत्पाद और उसका मूल राज्य/केंद्र-शासित प्रदेश सही ढंग से मेल खाता है?

- (a) Lakadong Turmeric — Assam
- (b) Ramban Honey — Himachal Pradesh
- (c) Nagauri Ashwagandha — Rajasthan
- (d) Thekua — Uttar Pradesh

Answer: c

PM showcases India's heritage at G7 with traditional gifts

- At the 52nd G7 Summit in France, Prime Minister Narendra Modi gifted global leaders a curated selection of GI-tagged and locally sourced Indian agricultural and textile products.



RAMBAN HONEY

- Ramban Honey, sourced from the Chenab Valley of Jammu and Kashmir, is known for its distinct flavour and nutritional value derived from the region's rich Himalayan flora.



LAKADONG TURMERIC

- Lakadong Turmeric, cultivated in Meghalaya's Jaintia Hills, is renowned for its exceptionally high curcumin content.
- The Geographical Indication (GI)-tagged product has gained recognition for its quality and health benefits, including antioxidant and anti-inflammatory properties.



NAGAUARI ASHWAGANDHA

- Nagauri Ashwagandha, originates from Rajasthan's Nagaur district and is regarded as one of the finest varieties of the medicinal herb.
- Widely used in Ayurveda, Ashwagandha is associated with improving vitality, immunity and overall well-being.



BANARASI SILK STOLE

- The Banarasi silk stole, woven by artisans in Varanasi(Uttar Pradesh), represented India's celebrated textile tradition.
- Known for its intricate zari work and detailed motifs.



THEKUA

- PM Modi also presented Thekua, a traditional delicacy from Bihar and Jharkhand to Slovakia's Speaker Richard Rai.
- Thekua is prepared using wheat flour, jaggery or sugar, ghee and fennel seeds. Closely associated with the Chhath festival, the sweet snack is known for its rustic flavour, long shelf life and deep cultural.

**34. Which country won the FIH Women's Nations Cup 2026?**

FIH महिला राष्ट्र कप 2026 किस देश ने जीता?

- (a) New Zealand
- (b) Australia
- (c) India
- (d) United States

Answer: (c)

India beat New Zealand to win FIH women's Nations Cup, title secure Pro League return

- In Hockey, India defeated hosts New Zealand 2-0 in the final in Auckland to win their second FIH Women's Nations Cup title and secured promotion to the FIH Women's Pro League.
- Lalremsiami won the 'Player of the Match' award
- Deepika finished as the joint-top scorer in the tournament with six goals to her name – sharing the honours with USA's Ashley Sessa.
- This is India's second Nations Cup title, having won the inaugural edition of the tournament in 2022.



35. Which country recently became the 11th member of the New Development Bank (NDB) and the first from Central Asia to join the institution?

हाल ही में कौन सा देश न्यू डेवलपमेंट बैंक (NDB) का 11वां सदस्य और इस संस्था में शामिल होने वाला मध्य एशिया का पहला देश बना?

- (a) Kazakhstan
- (b) Uzbekistan
- (c) Turkmenistan
- (d) Kyrgyzstan

Answer: (b)

Uzbekistan officially joined the New Development Bank (NDB)

- Recently, Uzbekistan officially joined the New Development Bank (NDB) as its 11th member, becoming the first country from Central Asia to become part of this BRICS-led multilateral development institution.
- The New Development Bank is a multilateral development bank established by the five BRICS countries – Brazil, Russia, India, China, and South Africa.
- The decision to establish the bank was taken at the **6th BRICS Summit held in Fortaleza, Brazil in 2014**
- It became operational in 2015



Headquarters: Shanghai, China

- The current membership includes:
- Founding BRICS members: Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa
- Bangladesh (joined in 2021)
- United Arab Emirates (joined in 2021)
- Egypt (joined in 2023)
- Algeria (joined in 2025)
- Colombia (joined in 2025)
- Uzbekistan (joined in 2026)
- In addition, Uruguay, and Ethiopia have been approved for membership by the Board of Governors. They will become full members once they complete the formal accession process..



36. Mona Khalil, who was recently in the news, was associated with the conservation of which of the following species?

मोना खलील, जो हाल ही में खबरों में थीं, निम्नलिखित में से किस प्रजाति के संरक्षण से जुड़ी थीं?

- (a) Dugong
- (b) Snow Leopard
- (c) Gharial
- (d) Sea Turtle

Answer: (d)



Prominent Lebanese turtle conservationist dies in Israeli strike: Who was Mona Khalil?

- Famous Lebanese conservationist and environmentalist Mona Khalil has succumbed to severe injuries after an Israeli strike hit her home.
- Khalil worked for the conservation of the endangered species of the green sea turtle, as well as the **vulnerable species** of the **loggerhead sea turtle**,



37. What is the primary objective of the BHARATI Programme?

भारती कार्यक्रम का प्राथमिक उद्देश्य क्या है?

- A. Increasing food grain production
- B. Promoting innovation in agri-food exports
- C. Expanding irrigation facilities
- D. Providing crop insurance

Answer: B

BHARATI Programme

- Recently, the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) has successfully concluded the first cohort of BHARATI Programme.
- BHARATI (Bharat's Hub for Agritech, Resilience, Advancement and Incubation for Export Innovation) is a flagship initiative of the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA).
- Aim: It is aimed at fostering innovation-led growth in India's agri-food export sector.
- It has been designed to empower 100 agri-food startups, drive innovation and boost exports worth USD 50 billion in APEDA-scheduled products by 2030.
- It is aligned with the Government of India's vision of an Atmanirbhar Bharat, Vocal for Local, Digital India and Start-Up India.
- **Focus categories:** It seeks to drive innovation in high-value categories such as GI-tagged agri-products, organic foods, superfoods, novel processed Indian agri-foods, livestock products and AYUSH products.

**38. Which of the following correctly describes the strategic significance of the Lipulekh Pass?**

निम्नलिखित में से कौन लिपुलेख दर्रे के रणनीतिक महत्व का सही वर्णन करता है?

- It connects Arunachal Pradesh with Myanmar
- It provides access to the Tibet region of China
- It links Sikkim with Bhutan
- It connects Ladakh with Central Asia

Answer: B

India-China border trade via Lipulekh Pass in Uttarakhand to resume after 6 years; 26 trade passes issued

- The first batch of 26 Indian traders is expected to enter the Chinese territory of Tibet through Lipulekh pass in Pithoragarh district of Uttarakhand
- Location: It is a high-altitude mountain pass located in the Kumaon region of Uttarakhand, near the trijunction of India, Nepal, and China.
- It links the Indian state of Uttarakhand with the Tibet region of China.
- Altitude: It lies at an altitude of approximately 5,334 meters (17,500 feet).
- Its elevation and strategic location make it a gateway to the higher reaches of the Himalayas.
- It is the first Indian border post opened for trade with China in 1992.

**39. India's first commercial-scale coal-to-ammonium nitrate project is being established in:**

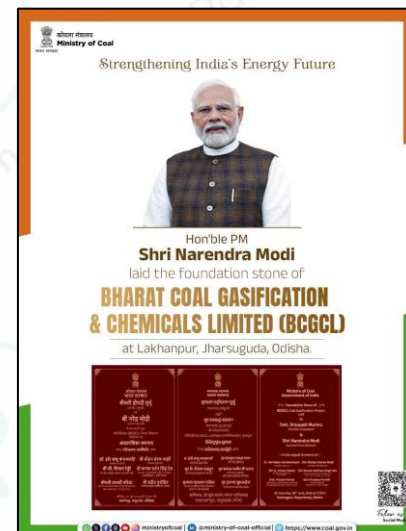
भारत की पहली व्यावसायिक पैमाने की कोयला-से-अमोनियम नाइट्रेट परियोजना कहाँ स्थापित की जा रही है:

- Chhattisgarh
- Bihar
- Odisha
- Madhya Pradesh

Answer: (c)

The Coal-to-Ammonium Nitrate Project

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone for India's first commercial-scale **coal-to-ammonium nitrate project at Lakhanpur in Jharsuguda district, Odisha.**
- The project is India's first commercial-scale industrial facility designed to convert raw domestic coal into ammonium nitrate.
- The project is being developed by Bharat Coal Gasification and Chemicals Limited (BCGCL), a joint venture between Bharat Heavy Electricals (BHEL) and Coal India (CIL).
- The facility will produce 2,000 tonnes of ammonium nitrate a day using coal gasification technology developed indigenously by BHEL



40. The Ambubachi Mela is celebrated annually at which of the following temples?

अम्बुबाची मेला निम्नलिखित में से किस मंदिर में प्रतिवर्ष मनाया जाता है?

- (a) Kalighat Temple
- (b) Kamakhya Temple
- (c) Tarapith Temple
- (d) Jwalamukhi Temple

Answer: (b)

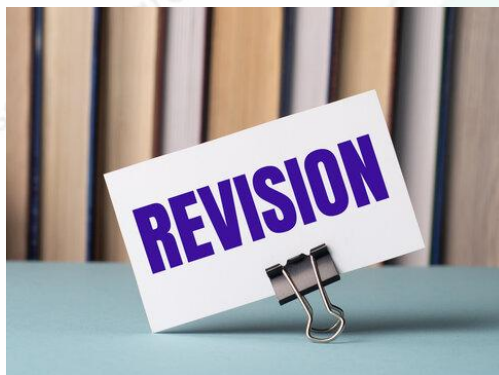
Ambubachi Mela

- The annual Ambubachi Mela which is one of the largest and most significant religious gatherings in eastern India started at the revered Kamakhya Temple.
- The Ambubachi festival is held during the monsoon, generally in June at the Kamakhya Temple in Guwahati, Assam.
- It is a shrine to the Goddess Kamakhya and one of the most important centres of Tantrik Shaktism.
- The period of Ambubachi is believed to be the period of the goddess's annual menstruation, and the shrine is closed for this.

The Kamakhya Temple

- Location:** It is situated on Nilachal Hill and adjoining the southern bank of the Brahmaputra River.
- It is one of the most revered centres of Tantric practices. It is regarded as one of the oldest of the 51 Shakti Peethas in India.
- It had been modelled out of a combination of two different styles namely, the traditional nagara and Saracenic or Mughal style of architecture.





Appointments

- The Mumbai Cricket Association (MCA) appointed former left-arm spinner Rajesh Pawar as chairman of the senior men's selection committee, while retaining Omkar Salvi as head coach .
- The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet approved the re-appointment of Senior Advocate Tushar Mehta as the Solicitor General of India for a further term of three years on 20 June 2026.
- UK Prime Minister Keir Starmer has officially announced his resignation.
- Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) Chief Financial Officer (CFO) Sunil Agrawal has resigned

AWARDS

- The Housing & Urban Development Department (H&UDD) of Jammu and Kashmir has secured two prestigious SKOCH National Awards, Gold and Silver, for its innovative and citizen-centric digital transformation initiatives during the SKOCH Awards Ceremony held in New Delhi.
- T.N. School Education Department wins SKOCH Award 2026 for 3 educational initiatives - — VETRI Palligal, TN SPARK, and Tamil Nadu Model Schools.
- 19th Mumbai International Film Festival -The festival's highest honour, the Golden Conch for Best International Documentary Film, was awarded to the Polish documentary Silver.

Obituary

- Malayalam poet and Padma Shri awardee P. Narayana Kurup dies at 92
- Eminent Buddhist scholar, professor, and author, Mr. Robert A. F. Thurman passed away

BOOKS

- Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh released the memoir of Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla, 'The Second Orbit: Belief of a Man... Dreams of 1.4 Billion Hearts', in New Delhi.
- Marathi novelist Rajendra Banahatti's My Last Autobiography, translator(english) Jerry Pinto, Kamal Desai's 1975 novella The Woman Who Wore a Hat, translated (english) by Shanta Gokhale

National

- Shri Amit Shah launched several important digital and farmer-centric initiatives of NAFED. These include NAFED-KALYAN scholarship for children of farmers and DRISHTI portal
- Recently, the Union Minister for New and Renewable Energy launched the Green Hydrogen Certification Portal of India (GHCI).
- Recently, the central government rolled out 'Nirbhay Chetna' to sensitise 17.5 lakh male elected representatives.
- The Union Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has designated Haldia seaport in West Bengal as an immigration post.
- The Indian passport is a "travel document" and not a "citizenship document"

- More than five decades after the Emergency was imposed in India, NCERT has, for the first time, introduced the topic in a Class 9 textbook, presenting it as "one of the major challenges," as the majority of fundamental rights were suspended.

State

- Ladakh has announced a ban on single-use plastics across the Union Territory, with authorities set to conduct random checks at Leh Airport and border entry points and impose strict penalties for violations.
- In Kashmir Valley, the annual Mela Kheer Bhawani is being celebrated with religious fervour and gaiety on the occasion of Jyeshtha Ashtami.
- The Delhi government has notified the 'Proactive Winter Air Quality Management Framework' to tackle air pollution more effectively during the winter months.
- Lieutenant-Governor (L-G) Taranjit Singh Sandhu instructed all departments to implement a 20% reservation for former Agniveers in direct recruitment to vacant Group C posts
- Indori Malwi Potato, Garadu and Balam kakdi from Madhya Pradesh Get GI Tag
- The President recently interacted with Cheetah Mitras and members of the Sahariya tribe at Kuno National Park in Madhya Pradesh's Sheopur district.
- Rajasthan constituted a high-level committee to prepare the draft of The Rajasthan Uniform Civil Code, 2026. The committee is headed by former Supreme Court judge Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai.
- Amaravati is set to get India's tallest observation wheel, surpassing the iconic London Eye.
- Tamil Nadu government has approved the "Vetri Thamizhagam" vision document.
- T.N. DGP orders all police officers to conduct 'Open Grievance Day' every Wednesday, Saturday

Science & tech

- Recently, the Indian Institute of Tropical Meteorology and the Aryabhata Research Institute of Observational Science Nainital have signed a long-term Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to establish a climate observation station in the Himalayan region under the Bharat Climate Observation Network (BCON).
- Teplizumab, sold as Tzield, is an immunotherapy drug for type 1 diabetes and is the first medicine designed to delay the onset of symptomatic stage 3 type 1 diabetes.
- The Ministry of Civil Aviation and Delhi International Airport Limited (DIAL) launched AIR SUVIDHA 2.0, an upgraded contactless Passenger Health Self-Declaration Portal, to strengthen public health surveillance at Points of Entry in response to the ongoing Ebola disease outbreak.
- ICAR-Central Institute of Brackishwater Aquaculture (ICAR-CIBA), Chennai, has successfully demonstrated Blue Swimmer Crab (*Portunus reticulatus*) farming technology for the first time using institute-produced hatchery seed and a scientifically formulated pelleted feed developed by ICAR-CIBA.

Environment

- Scientists recently discovered a new species of forester moth named *Mimeusemia kali* in Karnataka's Kali Tiger Reserve in the Western Ghats.
- To help gather better data on Indian butterflies, Kunte has collaborated with Nature's Ark to develop two mobile Android apps, iButterfly Explorer and iBiodiversity Count. These apps are specifically targeted at Indian butterflies,
- A new study reports the first confirmed record in India of the Sistan sand boa (*Eryx sistansensis*), a species formally described only in 2020 and previously known from Iran and Pakistan.
- Bangladesh joined the International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) as its 27th member nation.

Index & Reports

- The Kempegowda International Airport (KIA) has been ranked as one of the world's most family friendly airports for 2026.
- Bengaluru Ranks Second in Asia's AI-Native Startup Clusters announced key findings from the Global Startup Ecosystem Report (GSER) 2026, unveiled at VivaTech Paris. ,
- According to the latest report by the United Nations Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD), India emerged as the world's leading ship recycling nation in 2025, capturing a top-ranking 35.4% global market share.
- The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI) is preparing to launch Index of Services Production (ISP) in July, 2026.
- China's LineShine supercomputer ranked first in the 67th edition of the TOP500 list.
- Union Minister Sarbananda Sonowal launches PortGPT mobile app, releases V.O.C. Port Authority Sustainability Report 2026
- In the 2026 edition of the Positive Impact Rating (PIR) for Business Schools, a global student-led assessment of societal impact, the Indian Institute of Management Bangalore (IIMB) earned an overall score of 9.7, substantially higher than the global average of 8.0.

International

- The European Parliament has passed the Return Regulation, a new anti-migration law that allows European Union (EU) countries to set up offshore deportation centers or return hubs in non-EU nations.
- Prime Minister of India, alongside French President Emmanuel Macron, participated in VivaTech 2026 in Paris to highlight India's vision for human-centric AI and expand bilateral digital cooperation.
- The two day BRICS Heads of Space Agencies (HOSA) 2026 meet began, theme is 'Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability'.
- The 10th Thailand-India Defence Dialogue was held in Bangkok, to review bilateral defense ties and discuss evolving security developments in the Indo-Pacific region.
- Under a historic Memorandum of Cooperation aimed at ending the West Asia crisis, the U.S. and Iran have agreed to downblend Iran's highly enriched uranium stockpile under strict International Atomic Energy Agency (IAEA) supervision.
- India strongly criticized Pakistan at the 62nd Session of the UN Human Rights Council (UNHRC), describing it as a "Frankenstein state" for allegedly nurturing terrorism as an instrument of state policy.

Sports

- The Indian women's 4x100m team won the gold medal on the final day of the Asian Relays Championships 2026 in Shangyu, the People's Republic of China,
- Cristiano Ronaldo became the first player to score in six different World Cup tournaments
- Chiranth Vishwanath from Bengaluru became the first Indian to win a race at the iconic Mobility Resort Motegi racetrack in Japan
- Star Indian javelin thrower Neeraj Chopra finished fourth at the Doha Diamond League in his first competition of the season, recorded a best throw of 85.69 metres in his third attempt.
- India's Commonwealth Games-bound boxers finished with a haul of 12 medals, including eight golds, at the invitational 56th Grand Prix Usti nad Labem in Czechia.

Banking / finance

- Recently, the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) rolled out the Drunix platform
- The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has approved the GARUDA (Green-Channel: AIF Rollout Upon Document Acknowledgement) mechanism, transitioning the Alternative Investment Fund (AIF) framework

- IEPFA Organises panel discussion on “Aapki Poonji Aapka Adhikaar – Learning and Way Forward”; Launches book: “Claiming the Unclaimed: Unlocking the Potential of Idle Financial Assets in India”

QUESTION OF THE DAY

‘Operation Chakra-VI’, launched on 25 June 2026, is associated with which organization?

25 जून 2026 को लॉन्च किया गया 'ऑपरेशन चक्र-VI' किस संगठन से संबंधित है?

- A. Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)
- B. Enforcement Directorate (ED)
- C. National Investigation Agency (NIA)
- D. Intelligence Bureau (IB)